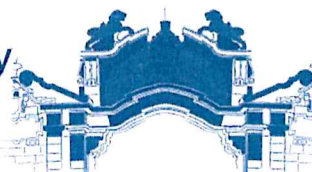




SEEK WISDOM, ELEVATE YOUR INTELLECT AND SERVE HUMANITY!

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STUDENT ADMISSIONS POLICY AND GUIDELINE

Approved by:	AAU Governing Board
Version:	1
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Document Review and Approval History

The Student Admissions Policy and Guideline at Addis Ababa University (AAU) was initiated for reform purposes by the Executive Management and the Board of Directors. This policy was meticulously drafted by relevant experts from the Colleges and Research Institutes, ensuring that it reflected the diverse expertise within the institution. To further enhance its quality, the document was enriched with comments and feedback from various Work Units, fostering a collaborative approach to policy development.

In addition, the policy was disseminated through a dedicated survey portal at <https://transform.aau.edu.et>, allowing for broader input from the university community. Following a comprehensive review process, the policy received endorsement from the University Council, Senate, and Executive Management. Ultimately, it was approved by the University Governing Board, signifying a unified commitment to the reform objectives outlined in the policy.



1. Background

Addis Ababa University (AAU) is the oldest and the Flagship University in Ethiopia, with a vision to become a leading research university in Africa advancing national needs and being responsive to global developments. AAU is mandated to pursue transformative education, cutting-edge research and innovation, and impactful services and engagement in advancing socio-economic, cultural, and technological needs and interests.

The prominent icon for AAU's long tradition of recruitment is Prince Bede Mariam Laboratory School, an exemplary high school for recruiting students in science teaching. Since 1974, student admission, particularly in the undergraduate regular program, was regulated by the Federal Ministry of Education (MoE). As of 2009, AAU embarked on recruitment and admission of students in the various graduate programs in different modalities (extension, distance, summer, and weekend). In its long journey of more than seven decades, AAU was able to cultivate over 281,024 graduates in certificate, diploma, bachelor, masters, and PhD programs in various fields of study.

More than ever, AAU is committed to producing future-ready graduates; contribute to the world of knowledge through cutting edge research and innovation and providing need-based community service. The transition of AAU to autonomy (Proclamation No. 1294/2023, Council of Ministers Regulation No. 537/2023) helped AAU re-imagine its future in terms of establishing a system for academic, financial and administrative freedom. At the core of realizing its re-imagined vision and mission lies the recruitment and admission of an optimal number of capable and talented students into its undergraduate and graduate programs. Moreover, attracting foreign students, opening campuses in foreign countries, and partnering with other Universities in offering joint degrees leverages AAU's prominence in the regional, continental and international academic arena. Therefore, this policy guideline caters for the special conditions for such drive of internationalization, and the overall student recruitment and admission practice should also be in line with the fundamental principles of ethics, diversity and inclusion.

The policy guideline document is contextualized within the relevant national policies (Education and Training Policy, Social Affairs Policy), Proclamation No. 1294/2023, Regulation No. 537/2023, and University Senate Legislation and Strategic Plan of 2024.



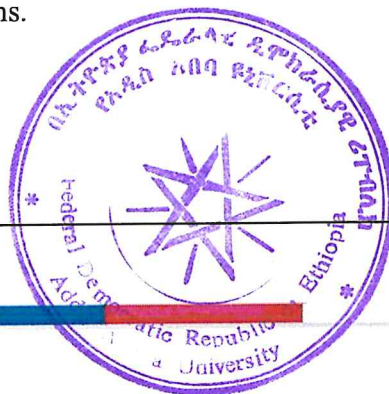
The University Autonomy Proclamation (Proclamation No. 1294/2023) underscores the fundamental tenets of academic freedom and autonomy, empowering universities to uphold their academic standards independently. The reasons that necessitate the development of this new Recruitment and Admissions Policy include, among others: the quest for exercising academic autonomy in the selection, recruitment, and admission of students; increased demand for higher education and societal expectation of the AAU as a gatekeeper of quality education; the need for streamlining admissions processes to ensure fairness, transparency, and alignment with institutional goals and values; and equity and diversity considerations in student admissions. Aligning admission practices with academic standards and objectives guarantees that incoming students not only meet academic requirements but also contribute to the overarching educational mission of the university. These guiding principles shape the admissions process, promoting fairness, integrity, and diversity in alignment with the core values and mission of the institution.

Moreover, the policy guideline is crafted to provide an overarching framework for student recruitment, admission and placement at AAU, as well as the procedures and conditions to be fulfilled for the successful implementation.

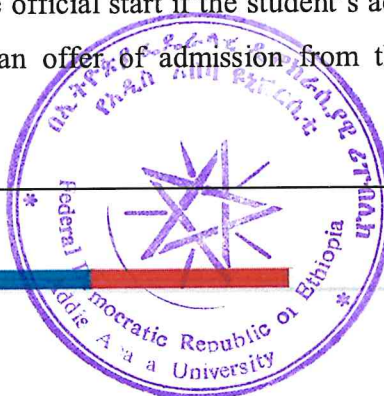
2. Definition of Terms

The following terms are used in the context defined below:

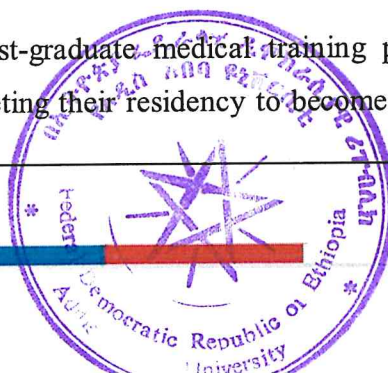
- i) **Academic Unit:** a college, an institute, a department, a school, or a center established as a constituent unit of the University.
- ii) **Admission:** the process through which prospective students' qualifications, academic records, test scores, and other relevant factors are assessed and students fulfilling the criteria are selected and granted entry into a specific academic program.
- iii) **Affirmative action:** refers to preferential policies and guidelines that help traditionally disadvantaged groups, such as female students, students with disabilities, students from under-privileged regions gain access to university admissions.
- iv) **Applicant:** an individual who has applied to the AAU or its constituent parts for admission into one of its study programs.



- v) **Aptitude test:** a university entrance examination that attempts to determine and measure a person's ability to acquire, through future training, some specific set of skills, such as intellectual, motor, among others, predicting future achievements.
- vi) **Assistantships:** a work opportunity, such as teaching or research support that provides graduate students to work while studying in exchange for a stipend and/or tuition waivers.
- vii) **Auditing of course:** attendance in a course on a non-credit basis.
- viii) **Bursaries:** awards to students by government departments, non-governmental organizations, private organizations, corporations, foundations, community groups, the University itself based on set criteria such as financial need, academic merit, field of study, disability, gender, socio-economic status, among others. While they do not need to be repaid, the donor decides what study-related costs are covered.
- ix) **Certificate:** a credential awarded to students/participants to demonstrate the development of specific career skills in a particular career or industry. A professional certificate program usually consists of focused training for a specific career. A professional certificate is credential that shows one's competency in a specific skill.
- x) **Diploma:** a credential that certifies a student's completion of a specific course of study or a set of experiences within a particular field, whose duration of study is less than bachelor's degree and lasting 1-2 years.
- xi) **Diversity:** refers to the presence and recognition of a variety of individual differences geographical origin, socioeconomic status, religious beliefs, among others.
- xii) **Double major:** a degree in which the number of credits taken is for two majors instead of one within AAU.
- xiii) **Dual degree/ Double degree:** is one which leads to separate awards from two partner institutions involved in a joint degree program or a dual degree award with two separate degrees in different or similar fields of study.
- xiv) **Enrollment:** the process that marks the official start if the student's academic journey at the University. It involves accepting an offer of admission from the University and officially becoming a student.



- xv) **Equal opportunity:** treating enrolled students without discrimination especially based on race, sex, age, national origin or disability.
- xvi) **Exchange program:** a short-term study program in which students spend one to two semesters studying at an international or domestic partner institution, as part of fulfilling their academic requirements.
- xvii) **Fellowships:** awards typically granted to graduate students in the form of a stipend to pursue advanced study or research often without requiring any work in return.
- xviii) **Financial aid:** money awarded to financially needy and academically competent students to pay for study-related costs such as tuition fees, accommodation, meals, and books as determined by the donor/funder.
- xix) **Graduate Program:** an advanced level of study designed to provide specialized knowledge, research skills, and professional training in a specific field or discipline and is pursued by students who have already completed an undergraduate program.
- xx) **Inclusion:** the principle and practice of ensuring that all individuals, regardless of ethnicity, gender, disability, geographical origin, among others, are treated equally.
- xxi) **International branch campus:** a campus of Addis Ababa University established outside the country, providing the same high standard of education as its campuses in Ethiopia.
- xxii) **International student:** a student who moves to a country other than their own for the purpose of studying in Addis Ababa University.
- xxiii) **Joint program:** an academic program that is offered jointly by two or more academic units of the University and/or a program that is offered by the University in collaboration with other institutions.
- xxiv) **Mature student:** an individual lacking an Ethiopian High School Completion Certificate or its Equivalent or having not completed 12 years of education but is 30 years of age or older by the start date of the study program in which they intend to enroll mature applicants may be admitted to undergraduate programs of the University if they demonstrate that they meet other requirements set out in this policy.
- xxv) **Medical fellowship program:** a post-graduate medical training program offered to medical school graduates after completing their residency to become a specialist in their

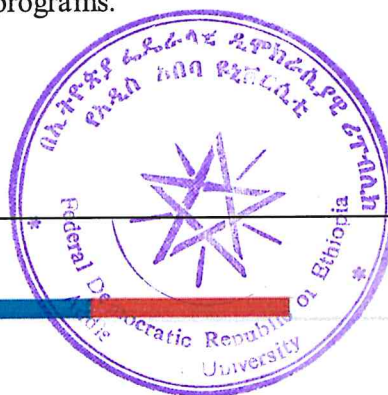


chosen field of medicine. The duration of a medical fellowship program varies depending on the particular subspecialty that an applicant chooses. During a medical fellowship, the physician (or “fellow”) works closely with a specialist to deepen their experience and knowledge of their subspecialty.

- xxvi) **Non-regular programs:** programs designed to cater for the training needs of individuals who could not pursue their studies in regular sessions because of time, financial, geographic, or other limitations. These programs are offered through various modalities such as evening classes, weekend classes, summer sessions as well as open, distance and e-learning.
- xxvii) **Placement:** the assignment of a student to a department of his/her choice.
- xxviii) **Postgraduate certificate programs:** specialized academic programs designed for individuals who intend to gain further expertise or credentials in a specific field. These programs, often shorter in duration, ranging from a few months to a year, offer concentrated study in a specific area, allowing participants to gain advanced knowledge and skills in that particular field.
- xxix) **Postgraduate diploma programs:** study programs pursued after completing an undergraduate degree and they offer more advanced and focused training in a particular field or discipline. These programs are often shorter in duration compared to master's degrees and are typically completed in a year or less. Postgraduate diploma programs are pursued by those seeking to enhance their knowledge and skills in their current field, switch careers, or prepare for further academic study at the master's degree level.
- xxx) **Postgraduate programs:** programs of study leading to an award, where entry into the programs requires students to have completed an undergraduate program in that particular discipline or in a related field from a recognized university or institution.
- xxxi) **Program:** a set of modules/courses in the undergraduate and graduate study disciplines.
- xxxii) **Recruitment:** the process of attracting and selecting prospective students to apply for admission to the university's academic programs.



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- xxxiii) **Registration:** the process of signing up for specific courses for a particular semester. It is a recurring process that happens at the beginning of each semester, where students select and enroll in the courses they plan to take.
- xxxiv) **Regular programs:** full-time study programs offered during regular academic sessions in which students typically focus solely on their academic studies.
- xxxv) **Residency program:** a postgraduate training program in a chosen medical specialty offered to those with a Doctor of Medicine (MD) degree from a recognized medical school or institution. The specialty chosen dictates how long the residency will last. The program is designed to give both hands-on experience and in-depth practical training to resident doctors, in one particular area of medicine, in order to prepare them to become fully certified physicians and practice independently in their core specialty.
- xxxvi) **Scholarships:** awards aimed at attracting and retaining exceptionally talented students and are based on academic excellence, artistic talent, or other outstanding achievement that the University deems its top priority. Scholarships usually have no employment conditions, repayments or general conditions attached to them.
- xxxvii) **Senate:** the Senate of the University established as per Article 17 of the University Autonomy Proclamation No.1294/2023.
- xxxviii) **Student:** any person who is admitted and registered at the University in the regular/evening/summer/distance/online or any other program with an intent to pursuing undergraduate or graduate degrees or up skilling.
- xxxix) **Student loans:** funds borrowed to pay for education expenses made available to students to pay. Loans are used to cover tuition fees and boarding expenses such as accommodation and meals.
- xl) **Students/Persons with disabilities:** as adopted from United Nation's definition of persons with disabilities; "those who have long-term physical, mental, intellectual or sensory impairments which in interaction with various barriers may hinder their full and effective participation in society on an equal basis with others"¹.

¹ United Nations (2006). *Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities*, Treaty Series, vol. 2515, New York.



- xli) **Transparency:** openness in intention, communication, and actions in pursuit of integrity, objectivity, and impartiality.
- xlii) **Tuition fees:** the instructional cost students are required to bear for their learning based on the number of ECTS or credit hours they take at Addis Ababa University.
- xliii) **Under-privileged regions/zones:** geographic areas within Ethiopia that the Federal Ministry of Education has designated in pursuit of its affirmative policy for placing students to public higher education institutions.

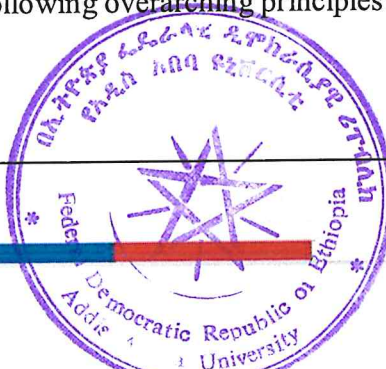
3. Purpose of the Policy

The aim of the Admissions Policy is to establish a transparent, well-coordinated and structured framework for the admission of students at AAU. The admission system ensures each institution has quantity and quality of students, economically sustainable and fulfills the access mandates. Thus, the purpose of this policy guideline is to create a vibrant, diverse and inclusive learning opportunity that benefits both the individual and student and the university as a whole. In specific terms the purposes are stated as follows:

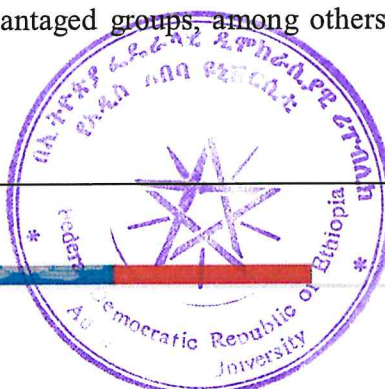
- a) provide principles, provisions and guidelines for recruitment and admissions students into UG, PG and special programs,
- b) establish equitable, transparent and rational processes for admission of students,
- c) ensure equity and diversity are the tenets of recruitment and admission processes in AAU, thus fostering a diverse student body,
- d) provide a framework for academic units to develop their recruitment and admission guidelines for selection and admission of prospective students.

4. Guiding Principles

This Admissions Policy and Guidelines promotes the values of excellence, equity and social justice through diverse mechanisms and strategies aimed at attracting and retaining students with academic potential as well as those from socially marginalized groups with limited access to higher education. In order to realize the recruitment and admission objectives set out, the admission process shall be governed by the following overarching principles:



- a) ***Equal opportunity:*** The policy shall afford equal opportunity to all applicants. However, AAU should take into account the applicants' contextual situations to ensure that no barriers intervene in terms of fairness, consistency, relevance, transparency, selection for merit and potential, diversity, professionalism, minimizing barriers to applicants, and timeliness.
- b) ***Flexibility:*** admission standards and processes should be flexible enough in order to allow for different pathways to AAU.
- c) ***Transparency:*** The recruitment and admission process should be clear and easy to understand. AAU should make it clear at the outset that information on available programs as well as eligibility and admission criteria is made available to the public well in advance. It should also ensure that adequate and timely responses are provided to questions and queries regarding the process.
- d) ***Fairness:*** There shall be consistency in the application of rules and regulations and no room for discriminatory practice. The admissions process should be designed in such a way that it is possible to redress wrongs committed in it. Particularly, admission decisions should be amenable to clearly signed procedures for complaints and appeals.
- e) ***Professionalism:*** There shall be a clear line of responsibility and accountability for all parties involved in the process; clear guidelines, regular training, and induction shall be provided for staff involved in the activity.
- f) ***Merit-based recruitment and admission:*** Admission decisions are made based on merit, regardless of any particulars of difference in age, disability, sex, nationality, financial status, marital status, pregnancy, race, religion or citizenship.
- g) ***Standards:*** AAU adheres to ethical standards, refraining from favoritism, discrimination, or any form of bias in the selection and admission processes;
- h) ***Internationalization:*** The policy guideline shall be designed, interpreted and implemented to meet the University's goals of internationalization, among others by becoming more attractive to international applicants and partnering institutions;
- i) ***Promoting equity, diversity and inclusiveness:*** As appropriate, the University shall put in place schemes/initiatives to encourage recruitment, admission and enrollment of students of diverse as well as disadvantaged groups, among others by putting in place affirmative actions.



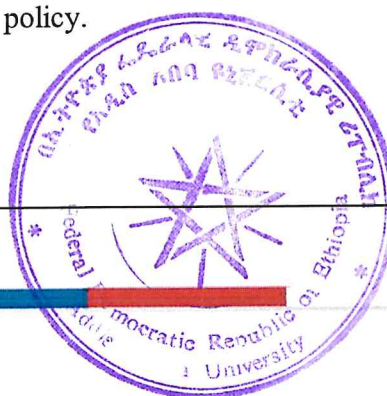
- j) ***Discrimination-free process:*** The admissions policy prioritizes impartial decision-making in accordance with the university's core values. The institution upholds a commitment to fostering a discrimination-free atmosphere where all members of the community, including potential applicants, are treated with courtesy and respect.

5. Scope and Application

The policy guideline informs admissions processes and requirements for all academic units running undergraduate and graduate programs in regular, continuing, joint and distance/e-learning. It also caters for professional certificate, post-graduate diploma and for courses tailored to specific themes on short-term basis. The recruitment section involves talent searches through events, in-person engagements and online in schools and beyond. Recruitment and admission of national and international applicants will be implemented based on the requirements set in this policy guideline.

Proper implementation of the recruitment and admission policy guideline will be ensured using clear identifications of the roles of key bodies, preparation and implementation guideline and regular monitoring and evaluation.

- a) The concerned Vice President oversees the proper implementation of the policy guideline;
- b) Admission and Enrollment Committee checks the recruitment and admission process, works on the possible outcomes of admission.
- c) The Registrar Office ensures the implementation of the policy by coordinating the works of colleges and other relevant offices;
- d) Colleges, schools and departments play crucial roles in implementation of the policy in their respective academic units;
- e) Applicants shall take the responsibility in meeting academic and non-academic requirements within the set deadline.
- f) The University President, concerned Vice President, Registrar, central academic program officers, deans and heads of academic units shall conduct periodic monitoring and evaluation on the implementation of the policy.



6. Policy Statement

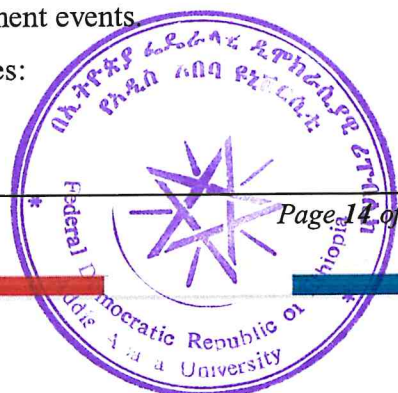
Addis Ababa University ensures that its Admissions Policy Guideline is robust and that admitted students have appropriate preparation for study. This Policy guideline focuses on promoting merit and academic excellence as well as fostering diversity of the university's student population by providing preferential treatment to historically underrepresented groups. In this respect, the University:

- a) ensures that admission and selection processes are governed by the overarching principles of merit, consistency, equity, fairness, transparency and timelessness,
- b) practices rigorous and holistic review to have full understanding of every candidate's academic and personal context in the process of evaluating their application documents,
- c) values diversity and inclusion and welcomes applications from students of all backgrounds and is committed to providing equal educational opportunities to all qualified applicants regardless of gender, disability, ethnicity, national origin or socioeconomic status,
- d) takes into account possible educational disadvantages when determining admission requirements,
- e) recognizes and values work experience and previous learning. It provides opportunity to individuals seeking admission to the university to have their previous qualifications and/or experience considered as the basis for admission, and
- f) is bound by agreements with partner universities or institutions to host exchange students and provide them with conducive conditions to pursue their studies without any inconvenience.

7. Student Recruitment

In order to maintain good student admission landscape, Addis Ababa University strategizes student recruitment plans as general recruitment plan and specific recruitment plans explained in this section. Recruitment will be part of the calendar, activities of the university and AAU pursues the following approaches in any of the annual recruitment events

- i. Branding of AAU by checking on the following issues:



- a. Relevant and timely answers to the “why study in AAU” on AAU website and social media channels
 - b. Tagline creation consistent with AAU brand
 - c. Ensure the student cohort demographics are reflected in AAU brand
 - d. Focus on AAU’s strengths and showcase them
- ii. Use engaging communication with all stakeholders
 - iii. Showcase university life in multiple ways
 - iv. Create digital and in-person events and,
 - v. Use alumni in the recruitment schemes
 - vi. Ensure inclusiveness in recruitment strategies

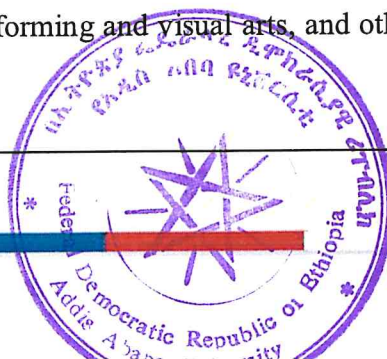
Moreover, Addis Ababa University and its academic units should devise various strategies and pursues the following recruitment plans with the aim of maintaining student admission with good landscape.

7.1. General Recruitment Plan

The recruitment plan of AAU that involves the digital and in-person events, outreaches and alumni engagement will be scheduled in the annual academic calendar. In this activity, the University showcases its programs by clearly addressing the “why study in AAU” through outreach events to schools across the country. During this event, departments can propose to join the outreach to at students to their programs. The time is expected to be scheduled once a year during school breaks or beginning of the second semester. Additionally, the digital event can be conducted anytime at any rate per year.

7.2. Special Recruitment Plan(s)

If an academic unit proposes recruitment plan that will be conducted in a different time of the academic year, a proposal shall be submitted to the concerned VP 4-6 months prior to the proposed date. The budget for the special recruitment plan shall be covered by the academic unit. Timeline of the proposed recruitment event should be in line with the University and the schools’ academic activities. Programs like sports, performing and visual arts, and others that recruit and



attract students from secondary school level and others like the education fields who may recruit and attract students from teaching force or from on job.

8. Student Admission

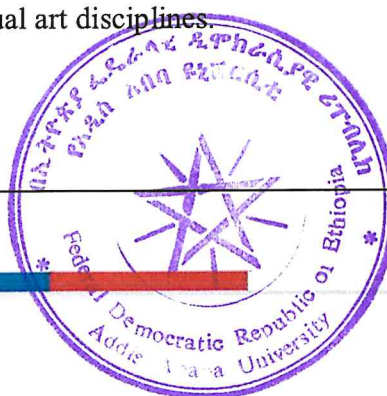
The admission requirements vary greatly depending on the programs. The following list includes specific requirements for admission into the University's regular and non-regular undergraduate, postgraduate and special programs. Because the non-regular programs should adhere to the same standards of quality as do the regular programs of the University, non-regular program applicants shall be considered against the same criteria as regular program applicants. Moreover, non-regular program applicants shall be admitted through the same admissions process.

8.1. Admission to Undergraduate Programs

Admission to the regular, extension and e-learning undergraduate programs could be either as a freshman, advanced standing, mature or transfer student. Admission will be made based on the following general and specific requirements.

8.1.1. General Requirements

- i. Residents of Ethiopia shall have the passing marks in the Ethiopian Higher Education Entrance Examination (EHEEE) administered by the Ministry of Education.
- ii. Non-residents of Ethiopia and foreign nationals shall provide equivalence evaluation of their credentials from the Federal Democratic Republic of Ethiopia Education and Training Authority (ETA).
- iii. Applicants should be able to take the Undergraduate Admission Test (UAT) of the AAU and get a passing mark. Alternatively, standardized tests such as IELTS, TOEFL, ACT, SAT, or LSAT and with the corresponding passing marks are acceptable.
- iv. Depending on the choice of discipline, additional assessments are set for applicants pursuing the medical schools (Medicine, Dental Medicine), Pharmacy, Performing and visual art disciplines.



- v. Applicants with EHEEE and UAT marks falling in the top 25% category will be selected for the additional assessments administered by the schools of Medicine, Dental Medicine and Pharmacy
- vi. Applicants in the International Branch Campuses of AAU shall process their application for admission as indicated in subsection 8.1.
- vii. Admission to joint programs is based on the signed MoU between AAU and partnering institutions

8.1.2. Specific Requirements

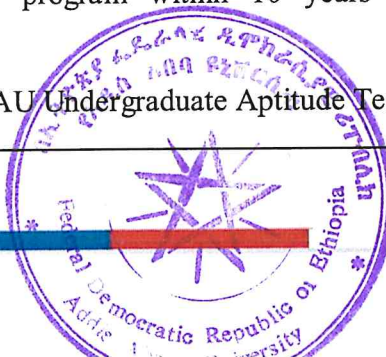
- i. Admission requirements on International Branch Campuses are subject to modification per the jurisdiction of the country, pending approval by the Senate.
- ii. Each program may have specific requirements such as minimum grades in certain subjects or additional entrance tests. Details will be posted on the respective program homepage on the AAU website.
- iii. The following minimum requirements are stated for the specific conditions listed below:

a) For applicants without EHEEE test:

- i. Technical and Vocational Education and Training (TVET) diploma (10+3 or 10+4) and level 4 Certificate of Competency (CoC) pass mark with one year of work experience, and
- ii. Successfully pass the AAU Undergraduate Aptitude Test (UAT).

b) For applicants with advanced standing status:

- i. Applicants must have completed a tertiary qualification equivalent to a diploma for which the AAU credit transfer is applicable,
- ii. Applicants must have a minimum Cumulative Grade Point Average (cGPA) of 2.75 on a 4.00 scale or its established equivalent,
- iii. At least 2 years of work experience in areas related to the academic program they seek admission to,
- iv. Completed their study program within 10 years from the time of application, and
- v. Successfully pass the AAU Undergraduate Aptitude Test (UAT).



c) For applicants with mature age:

- i. Applicants without 12 years of education but with proven relevant study, work and/or life experience and capacity for university education may be considered for admission on a case-by-case basis.
- ii. Applicants over 30 years of age who can produce evidence of their experience which may include a Curriculum Vitae (CV) that documents broadly relevant work experience not less than 5 years, professional references, evidence of informal or non-informal study that is completed (partially completed),
- iii. Such applications shall be submitted to the Head of the relevant academic unit to scrutinize the academic background and work experience, together with appropriate entrance assessment on a case-by-case basis.

8.1.3. Undergraduate Admission Procedure

The undergraduate regular, extension and e-learning programs are encompassed in the procedure that includes verification of admission requirements; retrieval of applications, verification of documents; evaluation of applicants; recommendations for admission; approval of applicants; issuance of admission letters; communication to applicants and faculties; endorsement of admissions list; preservation of admissions records; and revocation of admissions. The guidelines complement and shall be applied together with other relevant frameworks to the extent that they make the process more efficient, faster and accountable.

1) Application via the AAU Portal System

During call for application, the application steps via the portal system will be detailed via all media and applicants will submit their required EUEE results along with their personal information leading them ready for the UAT test scheduling.

2) UAT Administration

Schedule for UAT test will be announced to applicants via the application portal in coordination with the testing center and the Registrar office. For accessibility, admission test centers out of AAU could be used.



3) Verification and Evaluation of Applications

The Admissions office of the Registrar shall continually verify all the applications received, follow-up and advice all applicants with incomplete documentation to complete their submission; including equation of foreign qualifications. Such verification may include contacting the other institutions attended by the applicant.

The Admissions office will continually evaluate applications against the set criteria, the authenticity of certificates, and prepare a weekly roll of two categories of applicants – Admissible and NOT admissible.

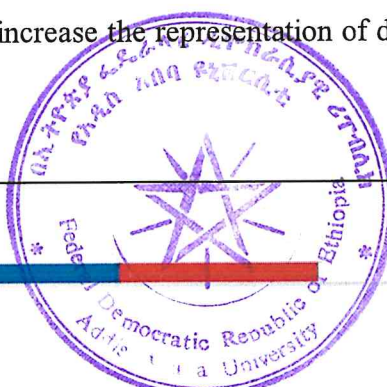
4) Recommendations and Endorsement for Admission

The Academic units shall prepare and verify a roll of recommendations for admission; for endorsement by the Academic Commission. This list shall be sent to the Registrar along with the endorsement minute.

5) Approval of Admissions

As part of the institutional enrolment management process the Admission and Enrollment Committee (AEC), in consultation with the Academic Units, determines annual enrollment targets of the University based on the number of places available. Based on these targets, places available for new students are generally filled as follows:

- a) All applicants who successfully passed the AAU UAT are ranked according to their test scores. Selection for admission is then generally based on the applicant's ranks and admission quota for Disadvantaged groups.
- b) Seventy five percent (75%) of the places are filled solely on the basis of students' UAT test scores.
- c) The remaining twenty five percent (25%) are reserved for disadvantaged groups of applicants which may include female students, students with disabilities, and students from under-privileged regions, as determined by the University Senate policies. The spots are then filled on the basis of the test scores and other specific criteria such as fields of study, applicant's specific needs and conditions. This affirmative action (admission quota) is designed to increase the representation of disadvantaged groups in AAU's student population.



- d) The following is the breakdown of places (of 25% of admission quota) reserved for disadvantaged groups:
 - i. 15% for female applicants,
 - ii. 5% for applicants with disabilities, and
 - iii. 5% for applicants from underprivileged regions.
- e) Applicants seeking admission under the Disadvantaged Groups Quota must complete special application forms (to be included in the application form that all students complete) and provide all required evidence of their eligibility. They will, however, be selected against the quota reserved for then according to merit.
- f) If any place reserved for disadvantaged groups remains vacant, it will be filled purely on merit-basis.

All names of students endorsed by the AC shall be presented to Senate for approval. Records of such approval and endorsement shall be maintained and updated by the Registrar.

The senate will also review and make decision on cases of special admissions and waivers of any of the admission requirements as available. Moreover, various strategies of accessibility may be used to address the admissions of female, disability and underprivileged regions.

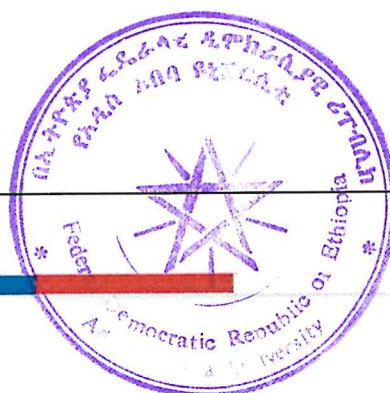
6) Issuance of Admission Letters

The University Registrar shall sign all letters of admission. Such letters shall be published in the student portal, and communication sent to the applicants and respective Colleges and Departments. The letters of admission shall be accompanied by all joining instructions, including fee structure.

7) Admissions Records

The following shall constitute admission records:

- a) Letter of application and supporting documents submitted
- b) Recommendation roll
- c) Minutes of AC
- d) Minutes of the Senate
- e) Admission letter and



f) **Joining instructions**

These records shall be maintained and updated for perpetuity by the Academic Registrar.

8) Communication with Admitted Students

College Associate Registrars, Deans, and Chairpersons of Departments shall maintain regular communication with each student admitted to the University for Purposes of transmitting any relevant information that may emerge from time to time.

9) Revocation of Admissions

Admission of any applicant may be revoked on the recommendation of the Department, and approval by Academic Deans and Senate if it is found that the applicant had submitted fake documents during application or been involved in any related misconduct.

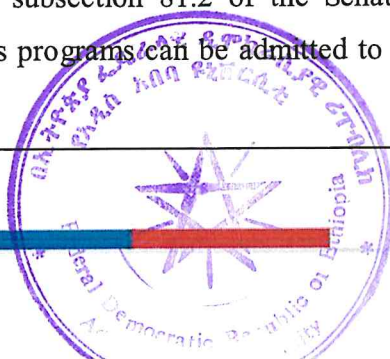
These procedures complement and shall be applied together with the relevant frameworks to the extent that they make the process more efficient, faster and accountable.

8.2. Admission to Graduate Programs

Admission to regular, extension and e-learning graduate programs will be processed based on the following general and specific requirements:

8.2.1. General requirements

- i. Admission must adhere to the national and international standards and expectations with a focus on quality and commitment to the advancement of science and knowledge production.
- ii. Proof of Bachelor's study with a minimum cGPA of 2.50 and a minimum cGPA of 2.75 in a relevant major on a 4:00 scale is a prerequisite for applicants seeking admission to MA/MSc/MPhil/LLM programs.
- iii. Proof of MA/MSc/ MPhil/LLM degree is a prerequisite for applicants seeking admission to PhD programs.
- iv. In accordance with Article 81, subsection 81.2 of the Senate Legislation, senior undergraduate students in honors programs can be admitted to graduate programs to



simultaneously follow the courses. Section 10 of this document will cater for such special admission conditions.

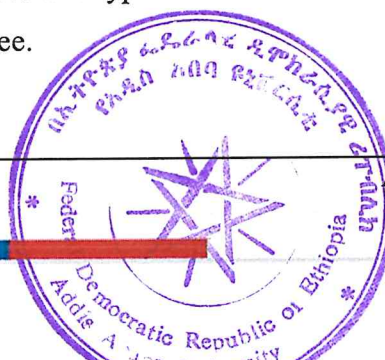
- v. Applicants should be able to take the Graduate Admission Test (GAT) of the AAU and get a passing mark. Alternatively, standardized tests such as IELTS, TOEFL, ACT, SAT, or LSAT and with the corresponding passing marks are acceptable.
- vi. Submit two (2) letters of recommendation from former university instructors or professors.
- vii. Submit a two-page letter of intent on why the applicant intends to join the Master's or the PhD program.
- viii. Produce, as may be required, certificate of work experience related to the desired field of study.
- ix. Academic units will require additional discipline-specific graduate admission assessments as relevant.

8.2.2. Specific requirements and special conditions

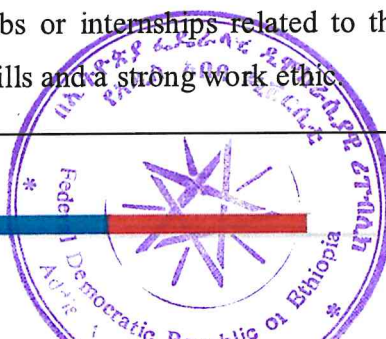
- i. Upon approval by the University management and the senate, academic units can establish joint graduate programs with foreign Universities, binding to a memorandum of Understanding (MoU) that shall set forth the terms and conditions for the collaboration and procedures for application, admission, and registration into the joint program meeting the interests of partnering Universities;
- ii. The Graduate Committee of the academic unit may include additional admission requirements in conformity with University's rules and regulations.
- iii. Some applicants might be required to take bridging courses, if judged necessary by the respective Graduate Committee of the academic unit. The number and type of courses to be taken will be decided by the respective Graduate Committee of the academic unit.
- iv. Applicants with a Master's degree by coursework or Master's degree in different fields of study might be required to audit course(s) or take bridging courses as a prerequisite for admission to a PhD program, if this is judged necessary by the respective Graduate Committee of the academic unit. The number and type of courses to be taken will be decided by the respective Graduate Committee.



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- v. To facilitate the internationalization of the student body and address complications related to degree authentication, the AAU shall establish procedures and relevant units for the verification of degrees received in foreign Universities. The AAU shall establish International Students' Office to assist with these and other administrative and legal requirements.
- vi. Residency programs shall be conducted in accordance with the national residency matching program. However, the College of Health Sciences can introduce additional requirements on top of the national ones in alignment with quality education and health care and maintaining the minimum requirements of AAU. Additional requirements proposed shall be approved and implementation channeled through the Registrar office.
- vii. Graduate applicants in the International Branch Campuses of AAU shall process their application per the admission requirements set forth by the AAU and jurisdictions of the host country.
- viii. Curricula for programs offered in International Branch Campuses of AAU shall be similar to the in-house campuses under the jurisdictions of the host country.
- ix. Admission to the graduate programs shall take place twice an academic year in the advertised program and modality (regular, summer, etc.). In special admission cases, admission would be processed upon approval so long as the academic units exhibit capacity to accommodate the student(s) in the proposed time.
- x. The University may determine special admission procedures for female students, students with disabilities, students from less developed regions, and students from nationalities with low participation in education due regard given to maintaining the standard of excellence of the University.
- xi. Academic units may further explore and utilize non-academic admission requirements as deemed necessary.
 - **Structured Interviews:** Some programs need to conduct interviews to assess applicants' communication skills, maturity, and motivation.
 - **Extracurricular Activities:** Involvement in clubs, sports, volunteer work, or other activities can showcase leadership, teamwork, and time management skills.
 - **Work Experience:** Part-time jobs or internships related to the field of study demonstrating practical skills and a strong work ethic.



- **Portfolios or Auditions:** For programs in the arts, a portfolio of work or an audition may be necessary to assess artistic talent and potential.

8.2.3. Criteria for Admission into the AAU's Residency Programs

To be eligible for admission to the Residency Program, an applicant must:

- i. Hold a medical degree (MD) or its equivalent from a recognized university or institution,
- ii. Meet the minimum cGPA requirement of 2.50 on a 4.00 scale or its equivalent, at the MD level,
- iii. Have successfully passed the Graduate Admission Test (GAT),
- iv. Have at least two years of work experience as a general practitioner,
- v. Produce official clearance for his/her previous professional service (up on the request after matching),
- vi. Provide two letters of recommendation from physicians (one from the medical school instructor/professor and the other one from current employer/immediate supervisor,
- vii. Provide a personal statement (two pages maximum) describing relevant skills, work experience, motivation for application and suitability to the program, and
- viii. Be in a good state of physical and mental health and provide an account of good conduct.

8.2.4. Criteria for Admission into the AAU's Medical Fellowship Programs

To be eligible for admission to the Medical Fellowship Program, an applicant must:

- i. Hold a medical degree (MD) or its equivalent from a recognized university or institution,
- ii. Have successfully completed a residency training programs in a relevant field from a recognized university or institution,
- iii. Have completed at least two years of clinical practice after completing residency program,
- iv. Be registered and licensed to practice medicine in his/her area of specialization in Ethiopia or his/her country of origin,
- v. Have successfully passed the Graduate Admission Test (GAT),
- vi. Produce official clearance for his/her previous professional service (up on the request after matching),



- vii. Provide three letters of recommendation from physicians (two from the medical school instructor/professor and the other one from current employer/immediate supervisor,
- viii. Submit a detailed CV with names of three referees and their contact addresses
- ix. Provide a personal statement (two pages maximum) describing relevant skills, work experience, motivation for application and suitability to the program, and
- x. Be in a good state of physical and mental health and provide an account of good conduct.

8.2.5. Criteria for Admission into the AAU's Doctor of Philosophy (PhD) Programs

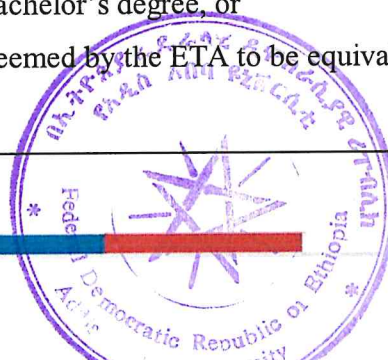
To be eligible for admission to the PhD Program, an applicant must:

- i. Hold a relevant Master's degree or its equivalent from a recognized university or institution,
- ii. Have successfully passed the Graduate Aptitude Test (GAT),
- iii. Submit three (3) letters of recommendation (two from the applicant's former University instructors/professors and one from the applicant's employer/immediate supervisor). In case the applicants are unemployed, they will be required to submit all the three letters of recommendation from their former university instructors/professors,
- iv. Submit a detailed CV with names of three referees and their contact addresses.
- v. Submit a brief (7 pages Maximum) research concept note (with title, research questions, objectives, significance, of the research, research methodology [materials and methods], facilities, funding source, advisors from within and outside the University, etc), that suites the respective academic unit where admission is sought, and
- vi. Produce, as may also be required, evidence of work experience related to the desired field of study.

8.2.6. Criteria for Admission into the AAU's Postgraduate Diploma Programs

An applicant to one of the AAU's Postgraduate Diploma Programs must:

- i. Hold a Bachelor's degree with a minimum cGPA of 2.5 on a 4.0 scale in the relevant discipline from a recognized University or institution, or
- ii. Have a tertiary education qualification from a recognized foreign university deemed by the ETA to be equivalent to a Bachelor's degree, or
- iii. Have a professional qualification deemed by the ETA to be equivalent to a Bachelor's degree, or



- iv. In exceptional cases, possess demonstrable experience or achievement as per the program requirements as deemed sufficient by the relevant academic unit, and
- v. Have a minimum of two years of work experience in the relevant discipline,
- vi. Pass a dedicated entrance examination administered by the relevant academic unit under the oversight of the Registrar office which provides logistic support.

8.2.7. Criteria for Admission into the AAU's Postgraduate Certificate Programs

An applicant to one of the AAU's Postgraduate Certificate Programs must:

- i. Hold a Bachelor's degree in the same or related discipline from a recognized University or institution, or
- ii. Have a foreign qualification deemed equivalent to a Bachelor's degree by the ETA, and
- iii. Have a minimum of one year of work experience in the field related to the certificate program,
- iv. Additionally, the Admissions and Enrollment committee of the Senate or its delegate (the relevant Academic Unit) may require applicants to demonstrate their suitability for admission by completing additional work and/or sitting for examinations or attend interview as deemed necessary,
- v. Full details on course requirements, mode of delivery and duration of study for Postgraduate Certificate Programs are provided for under relevant Academic Units.

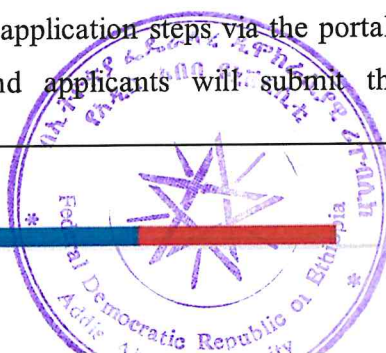
8.3. Graduate Admission Procedure

A. Announcement

Under normal circumstances, the concerned academic units shall send the request for central announcement for registration few weeks ahead of the stipulated registration time. As admission can take place twice an academic year, announcements for such programs should be started at least one month prior to the registration time.

B. Application via the AAU Portal System

During call for application, the application steps via the portal system will be detailed via all media and applicants will submit their required



documents detailed on section 5.2, along with their personal information leading them ready for the GAT test scheduling.

C. GAT Administration

Schedule for GAT test will be announced via the available mainstream media and the AAU homepage.

D. Verification and Evaluation of Applications

The Admissions office of the Registrar shall continually verify all the applications received, follow-up and advice all applicants with incomplete documentation to complete their submission; including equation of foreign qualifications. Such verification may include contacting the other institutions attended by the applicant.

The Admissions office will continually evaluate applications against the set criteria described in Section 5.2, the authenticity of certificates, and prepare a weekly roll of two categories of applicants – Admissible and NOT admissible.

E. Recommendations and Endorsement for Admission

The Academic units shall prepare and verify a roll of recommendations for admission; for endorsement by the Academic Commission. This list shall be sent to the Registrar along with the endorsement minute.

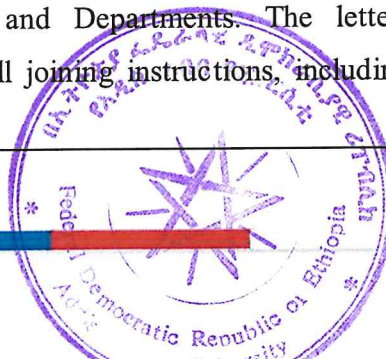
F. Approval of Admissions

All names of students endorsed by the AC shall be presented to Senate for approval. Records of such approval and endorsement shall be maintained and updated by the Academic Registrar.

The senate will also review and make decision on cases of special admissions and waivers of any of the admission requirements as available.

G. Issuance of Admission Letters

The University Registrar shall sign all letters of admission. Such letters shall be published in the student portal, and communication sent to the applicants and respective Colleges and Departments. The letters of admission shall be accompanied by all joining instructions, including fee



structure.

H. Admissions Records

The following shall constitute admission records:

- a) Letter of intent, CV and supporting documents submitted
- b) Recommendation letters
- c) Concept note
- d) Minutes of AC Deans
- e) Minutes of the Senate
- f) Admission letter and
- g) Joining instructions

These records shall be maintained and updated for perpetuity by the Academic Registrar.

I. Communication with Admitted Students

College Associate Registrars, Deans, and Chairpersons of Departments shall maintain regular communication with each student admitted to the University for Purposes of transmitting any relevant information that may emerge from time to time.

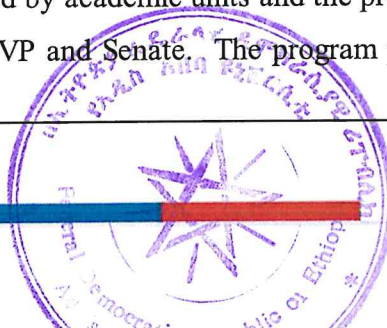
J. Revocation of Admissions

Admission of any applicant may be revoked on the recommendation of the Department, and approval by Academic Deans and Senate if it is found that the applicant had submitted fake documents during application or been involved in any related misconduct.

9. Admission to Non-degree programs/ Short-term Certificate Courses

Addis Ababa University offers short-term training courses in a range of disciplines. The principal objective of short-term courses is to update and deepen knowledge in various fields and boost specific skill sets. The clock hour or credit hour requirements is dependent on the program type, nonetheless, it won't go below 40 clock hours or 2.5 credit hours, ranging from few days to several weeks.

Non-degree programs are usually proposed by academic units and the process of approval passes through the Colleges/centers, concerned VP and Senate. The program package including calls,



admission and registration will be conjointly processed by the academic program and the Registrar.

Certificate Programs: focus on specialized skills and knowledge in various professional fields. They often provide practical training.

Short-term Courses: These courses focus on specific skills and are often intensive and practical.

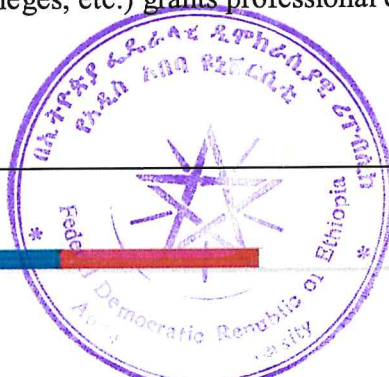
Work-Based Training: it includes different forms of on-job trainings. These programs allow individuals to gain practical experience while learning specific skills relevant to their chosen industry.

Postgraduate Certificate: provides focused knowledge in a specific area and serves as a stepping stone to further study or career advancement. Postgraduate Certificate is awarded for the attainment of a minimum of 30 ECTS credits at post bachelor's level.

Postgraduate Diploma: represents a deeper level of expertise beyond the certificate level and is suitable for professionals seeking specialized skills or knowledge. A Postgraduate Diploma is awarded for the attainment of a minimum of 60 ECTS credits at post bachelor's level.

Massive Open Online Courses and Online Micro-Credentials: are online courses offered on a wide range of topics and are accessible to anyone interested. Online micro-credentials programs allow learners to gain expertise in specific areas without pursuing a full degree in a flexible and self-paced manner.

Competency-Based Education Programs: Competency-based education focuses on demonstrating mastery of specific competencies or skills rather than completing a fixed number of credit hours. These programs emphasize practical application in a self-paced manner. Collaborative certification program jointly developed and implemented by the private partner/industry and an academic unit of AAU (departments, centers, institutes, colleges, etc.) grants professional certificate.



General conditions for Addis Ababa University's Short-term Certificate Courses

- a) Certificate students need to satisfy the academic and other relevant eligibility requirements set by the appropriate academic unit (this could vary depending on the certificate program that applicants want to join)
- b) In exceptional cases, applicants who lack formal academic qualifications but who demonstrate extensive and appropriate professional experience may be considered for admission, subject to the discretion of the University
- c) All the participants who successfully complete requirements of the short-term courses will be awarded a Certificate of Completion to recognize expertise, or skills gained that is jointly signed by the Head of the relevant Academic Unit and the Coordinator of the course
- d) Full details about contents of short-term courses, their duration and application requirements are provided for under the relevant Academic Units.

10. Special Admissions

As per *Article 81* of the AAU Senate Legislation, the following modalities are entertained under special admissions

A. Admission to Double Major Degree

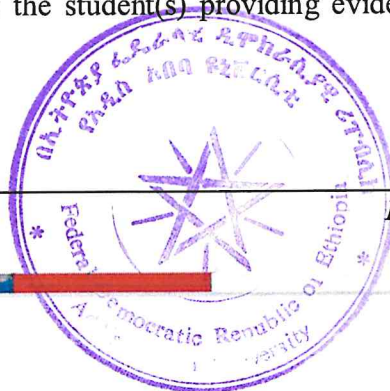
In the presence of applicants towards double degree, the respective Colleges must apply on behalf of the applicants providing evidence for the following:

- a) The student(s) can allocate the required time slots for both subjects for the successful completion of each degree as per the curricula
- b) Agreement from each academic unit regarding the students' enrollment majoring the courses of the two units.

B. Admission to Dual Degree/ Double Degree

i. Dual Degree in two complementary bachelor's degrees

Colleges must apply on behalf of the student(s) providing evidence for the following:



- a) The student(s) can allocate the required time slots for both subjects for the successful completion of each degree as per the curricula,
- b) Agreement from each academic unit regarding the students' enrollment

ii. Dual Degree in a combined bachelor's and master's degree

This dual degree type is for senior year students with provided witnesses of exceptional talents per Sub-article 78.2 shall be granted admission to graduate programs to pursue their senior undergraduate programs with the year I graduate programs.

iii. Dual degree in two master's degrees covering different subjects

This dual degree type can be granted so long as the student can provide proven witness of his/her time and dedication for the course works and thesis works in the provided study period.

C. Admission to a Joint Degree

The admission requirements to joint programs should meet the standard policies of the partnering institutions. The admission requirement to joint programs shall be negotiated and agreed in the MoU signed between the partnering institutions.

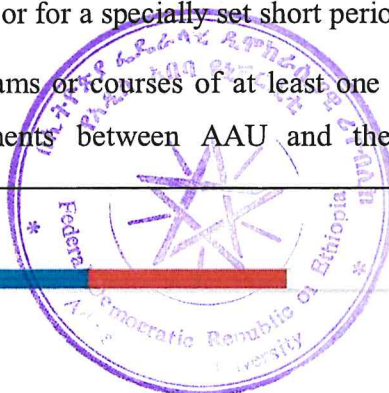
D. International Students

In recognition of the AAU's internationalization efforts, the University will encourage admission of qualified non-Ethiopian students. Particulars included in sections 8.1 and 8.2 of this Policy Guideline will govern admission of international students to undergraduate and graduate programs.

E. Exchange Programs

AAU offers exchange programs in various disciplines to international students and students from partner universities in the country. Students may study at AAU for a semester, a year or for a specially set short period.

Students staying at AAU for programs or courses of at least one semester under academic exchange agreements between AAU and their home



universities are enrolled as Exchange Students.

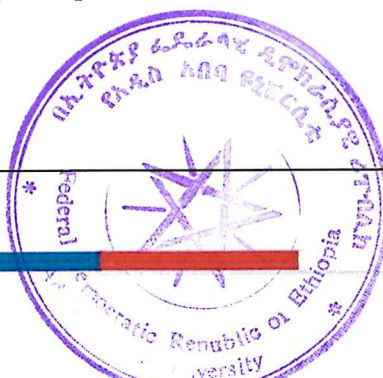
The terms of the stay at AAU for exchange students from partner institutions are defined by the governing partnership agreement, typically in the form of a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU). Often, the partnership agreement is based on a principle of a reciprocity governing exchange of students and tuition waiver though personal expenses remain the obligation of the student. In general, students under academic exchange agreements must:

- i. Be enrolled at their home institution in a degree program at the time of application and for the duration of their studies at AAU,
- ii. Be nominated by their home university,
- iii. Have good English proficiency,
- iv. Be in good health, provide evidence of relevant travel vaccinations, getting ready to stay in Ethiopia,
- v. Demonstrate a strong interest and readiness to live in Ethiopia and live in the culture, different from the home country.
- vi. Have successfully completed at least two semesters of degree studies at their home University, and
- vii. Have sufficient financial resources to cover all personal costs of living for the duration of studies in AAU, including transportation, visa fees, accommodations, medical and health insurance, food and any other fees or personal living expenses.

Admission of students in exchange programs will be processed once the hosting academic unit requests for admission enclosing all the required immigration documents and academic credentials. The academic unit shall explicitly request admission to a course, set of courses and/or research-based thesis. Based on the approved documents, the university registrar shall process admission and opens the portal for registration of the course(s) or the thesis. After successfully completing the exchange activity, the academic records will be delivered to the student and be sent to the relevant University per request. The information, once completed, will be archived in the ISIMS.



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11. Transfer of students

Transfer of undergraduate and graduate students shall be processed as per Articles 84 and 108 of the Senate Legislation respectively.

Notwithstanding article 84 and 108 transfer from any Accredited Higher Education Institutes to Addis Ababa University requires the approval of student Admission and enrollment committee. Considering the existing and upcoming scenarios, transfer cases and actions are categorized as follows:

Scenario 1: Inter-University Transfer of Undergraduate Students on Cost-Sharing Basis

Transfer of an undergraduate student on set days between semesters shall solely be based on justifiable medical conditions beyond the control of the student. Nevertheless, the applicant shall fulfill the criteria listed below:

- a) Verifiable Medical Board certificate from Governmental Hospital, preferably Tikur Anbessa Specialized Hospital, explaining the medical issue and the subsequent decision in favor of transfer
- b) A letter from the host university indicating consent to the requested transfer
- c) No “F”, “NG”, “I” or “DO” grades on the grade report
- d) Should take less than 50% of the courses for the program completion

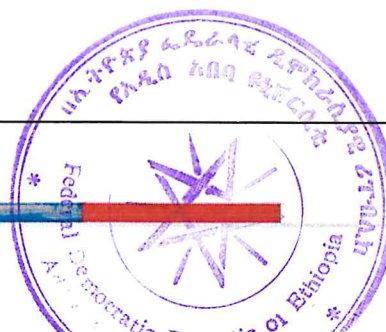
Scenario 2: Inter-University Transfer of Undergraduate Students on Self-Financing Basis

Requests of transfer of undergraduate students who wish to join a department in a self-sponsored scheme should be assessed along with the incoming applicants. The students should (i) be able to provide evidence of settled payment for their previous study and, (ii) have taken the EUEE within the previous two years of time. Applicants should process their application based on the criteria set and procedure stated on section 8.1 of this document. Once the criteria are fulfilled, exemption to the previously taken common courses shall be decided based on the recommendation of the academic unit.

Scenario 3: Transfer of Undergraduate Students from Accredited Universities/Colleges Overseas



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Requests of transfer of foreign or non-resident undergraduate students who wish to join a department in a self-sponsored scheme from other university overseas shall provide the following in order to process their application:

- a) A transcript/grade report authenticated by the relevant officials and the ETA
- b) Letter from the ETA indicating eligibility of the applicant to join the University
- c) Application/ motivation letter for joining the program in AAU

The procedure stated on section 8.1 of this document works for the applicants in scenario 3. Once the procedure is completed, the relevant academic unit will work on the equivalence and exemption of courses and decision will be forwarded to the registrar for processing of the admission.

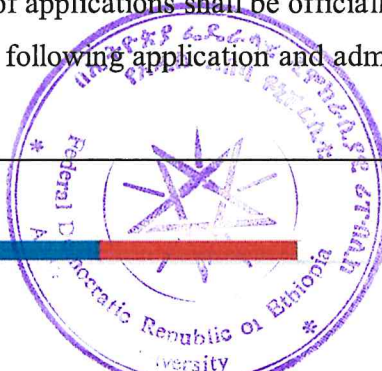
Scenario 4: Inter-University Transfer of Graduate Students

A graduate student could be transferred to a graduate program of Addis Ababa University provided the following criteria are fulfilled:

- i. The graduate student/ applicant should have been enrolled in a graduate program of another a recognized university offering similar field of specialization and equivalent courses.
- ii. The graduate student needs to submit an application letter to the department/school. The graduate coordinator of the academic unit presents the case for discussion by the College Graduate Committee and AC.
- iii. The graduate student shall enclose evidence for the completion of not more than one third of the course work (one semester) and obtained a satisfactory result.
- iv. Transfer cases shall be entertained based on the availability of space, supervisors and other required resources in the department/school.
- v. Transfer of credits shall be determined by the Academic Units receiving the candidate.

12. Application and Admission Calendar

Opening and closing dates for the submission of applications shall be officially announced by the University. In general, the university uses the following application and admission calendars for its different programs:



12.1. Undergraduate Programs

Admission is granted to successful undergraduate program applicants in August to mid-September every year.

12.2. Graduate Programs

Applications for graduate programs are open throughout the year and are reviewed on a rolling basis. However, admissions are granted twice in one academic year: August and December.

12.3. Exchange Programs

Application periods for exchange programs align with those of the relevant programs.

13. Appeals, Withdrawal Readmissions and Refund

13.1. Appeals

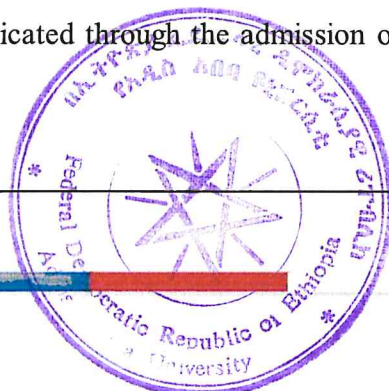
Addis Ababa University (AAU) is committed to ensuring a fair, transparent, and accessible process for addressing appeals and complaints related to admission decisions. Students should follow the following procedure if they wish to appeal a decision or lodge a complaint.

Grounds for appeal are stated as follows:

- a) Procedural errors or irregularities
- b) New evidence not available at the time of the original decision
- c) Perceived bias or unfair treatment

Appeal Procedure

- a) Appeals must be submitted within 10 days of the decision notification.
- b) Students must submit a completed appeal form, a written statement detailing the grounds for appeal, and any supporting evidence.
- c) Appeals should be submitted to the admission office portal, email or in person.
- d) A decision will be made within 10 days of receiving the appeal by the admission committee and will be communicated through the admission office in writing to the student.



13.2. Withdrawal

Per article 91 for undergraduate programs and article 117 for graduate programs, withdrawal based on valid and justifiable reasons are categorized as voluntary and involuntary withdrawal types.

i. Voluntary Withdrawal

- a) Students wishing to withdraw must notify their department/advisor and the Registrar's Office.
- b) Completion and submission of the withdrawal form are required.
- c) Students must adhere to withdrawal deadlines to avoid academic penalties.
- d) Withdrawal deadline will be indicated in academic calendar
- e) Withdrawal before the deadline will result in a "W" grade, which does not affect the GPA.
- f) Withdrawal may affect tuition fees and financial aid eligibility.

ii. Involuntary Withdrawal

Involuntary withdrawal may occur due to: Academic failure, Disciplinary actions, and Health or safety concerns.

- a) Students will be notified in writing of the reasons for involuntary withdrawal.
- b) Students have the right to appeal the decision within 10 days of notification.

13.3. Readmission

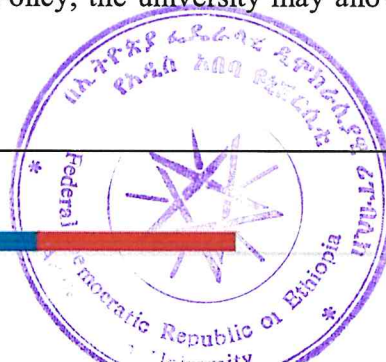
Readmission of undergraduate and graduate students shall be processed as per Articles 82 and 117 of the Senate Legislation respectively. Readmission for cases under voluntary withdrawal shall take the previous fee into consideration to restart the study. If there is any change in the rate, the student should be paying the difference between the rates to continue his/her study.

13.4. Refund

Based on the provisions stated in the AAU's Fee Policy, the university may allow refund to be administered.



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i. Refund eligibility

Students may be eligible for refunds if they:

- a) Withdrew within the designated refund period
- b) Face exceptional circumstances (e.g., medical issues)
- c) The Refund proportion is as stated on the AAU's tuition fee policy guideline.

ii. Procedure for Refund

- a) Complete the refund request form.
- b) Provide supporting documents (e.g., medical certificates).
- c) Submit the form and documents to the Finance Office.
- d) Refund requests will be processed within 20 days of submission.
- e) Students will be notified of the refund status via email.

iii. General Provisions

The university will maintain records of all appeals, withdrawals, and refunds for accountability and future reference. For the right to appeal and timing of appeal, AEC shall announce decision of appeals in due course.

14. Fees Status and Assessment, Funding and scholarship

Tuition fees

Except those benefiting from student financial aid programs, AAU offers its programs on a fee-paying basis, which vary with programs. The various categories of fees (fees for admission, enrollment, tuition, examination, etc.) charged by AAU shall be set out in the University Fees Policy.

Prospective students admitted into AAU study programs could only register after they paid their tuition and other required fees or produced documentation proving their participation in student financial aid programs.

With respect to the payment of tuition and other related fees at the University, students will be required to comply with the following procedures to be officially registered at the University.

- i. Tuition fees and non-tuition fees are assessed on a semester basis and shall be paid in the specified due date,



- ii. Self-sponsored students may choose to pay their tuition fees either in full, or in two installments according to a deadline established by the Registrar and shall be fully paid by the due date,
- iii. Students benefiting from Ethiopian Government Supported Student Loan Scheme (Cost-sharing Scheme) are responsible for completion of forms required to establish the loan,
- iv. Students enrolling in AAU Scholarship/Fellowship/Assistantship supported place must accept the offer of the place in writing and are responsible for completion of forms required to establish the AAU Scholarship/Fellowship/Assistantship support, and
- v. Beneficiaries of bursary awards must secure an official letter from their benefactors addressed to the University clearly indicating their willingness and readiness to cover tuition fees. These payments shall be paid per (i) above, based on a letter from the College/University registrar indicating the amount to be paid for the semester.

In case where self-financing students are unable to finance their fees, the AAU management, via the AVP shall decide whether to move the applicant to scheme ii, based on the available funding.

15. Admission and fee scheme of staff Children and Spouses

As part of staff benefit package, children and spouse of a staff will get priority in admission into a program of their choice as long as they meet the minimum requirements of admission to AAU. This will apply for staff who have passed away or who has left the University, so long as they served the University for at least 10 years.

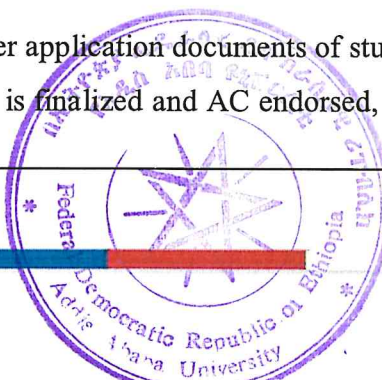
16. Responsible offices for Recruitments and Admissions

i. The AAU Registrar

The admission office of the Registrar is primarily responsible for processing primary application, contacting applicants for incomplete document submission and internal verification of the submitted documents.

ii. College Registrar

College registrars shall carefully deliver application documents of students to the relevant Departments/ Schools. Once decision is finalized and AC endorsed, they are responsible



to collect all documents of accepted applicants and channel it to the main registrar. They are also responsible for processing the registration of admitted, readmitted and transferred students in all the programs

iii. The Testing Center

The Testing Center is the primary center for administering admission tests (UAT and GAT), scheduling and managing of the testing.

iv. The Academic Dean

Academic Deans are responsible for summoning the AC for endorsement the accepted UG and PG applicants. In cases of special admissions, the Deans shall provide their review of the cases along with the pros and cons of the cases and their final decision. The academic Deans shall decide on all sorts of intra-university transfer requests.

v. The Department/ school Heads/Chairs

Departments/ Schools, via their DGCs, shall scrutinize UG and PG application documents forwarded from the college Registrars and forward their decision based on the provided documents and additional selection processes. They are also responsible for preparing proposals for joint degrees.

vi. The Senate

The Senate is responsible for approval of joint programs, admissions, special admissions and revocation of admissions. The senate shall also monitor the admission and recruitment guideline based on the frameworks specified on Section 15 of this document.

vii. The Admission and Enrollment Committee (AEC)

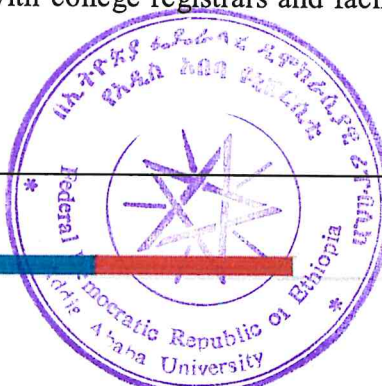
Established by the Senate, the AEC shall work on complaints and appeals on admission and transfer cases in conjunction with the AVP, and communicates the outcome with the individuals via the Academic Registrar.

viii. Associate Deans

Associate Deans are responsible for taking an active role in student recruitment events, by pinpointing and working with the relevant Department chairs/School Heads. They will also work in close collaboration with college registrars and facilitate for the timely completion of the admission process.



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ix. International students Desk

Established under the office of the External relations and Strategic Partnerships, the Desk is responsible for communicating with foreign students from each program and become a relevant resourceful desk in every aspect of the students' requirements. The desk is responsible to schedule and organize welcoming events, visits to important spots on the daily lives of the students (shopping spots, city libraries, recreational parks...). The desk is also responsible for arranging language training sessions in collaboration with the relevant academic units.

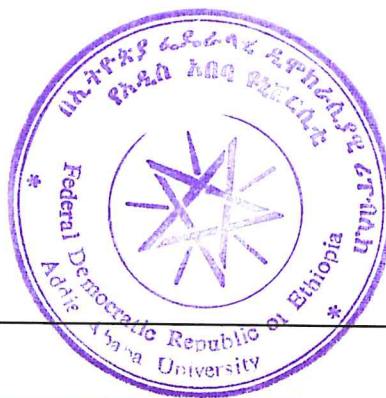
17. Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning (MEL)

The MEL will establish a system of adaptable frameworks with processes, best practices, and tools that are strategically tailored for achieving increasing number of students admitted to AAU.

The MEL system will:

- a) Guide the design, implementation and review of the recruitment admission policy
- b) Enhance the processes of enhancing excellence and attractiveness in the study programs of AAU
- c) Ensure appropriate performance indicators are in place in all the programs
- d) Ensure effective recruitment and build trust in the society
- e) Strengthen knowledge generation, management and translation; and
- f) Facilitate transparency and accountability

The applicability of the policy guideline shall be monitored continually and evaluated annually by the Senate for continued applicability.

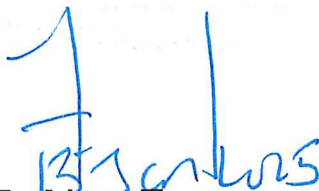


18. Amendments

The guideline section of this document shall be reviewed annually for continued relevance and applicability depending on the prevailing conditions.

19. Effective Date

This policy guideline shall come into effect as of August 28, 2024.


Frehiwet Tamru

Chairperson of the Governing Board of Addis Ababa University

